

08/07/26

## Free Talk

International Day - An annual school event in Singapore that celebrates friendship, cultural diversity, and global understanding.

A nationwide school event 全国性的学校活动

Be on your phone/use your phone 玩手机/看手机

Singapore's Ministry of Education (MOE) 新加坡教育部

Malatang / Mini hot pot 麻辣烫 - 麻辣烫在国外已经很出名了，所以不需要专门翻译了（哈哈）

Raw marinated seafood 生腌

Feed tongue 牛舌

Stand 摊位

booth 展位

Singapore is a blend of different cultures. 新加坡融合了不同

Layover 转机 （坐飞机的时候转机）

Cultural melting pot 文化大熔炉



## Homework Analysis

### Question 1 (f) Summary

Read **Text B, Zozu's story**, in the insert, and answer **Question 1(f)** on this question paper.

- (f) According to Text B, what are the reasons why changes to animal migrations have occurred and why are these changes worrying?

You must **use continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 120 words.

**Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.**

Changes in migration have happened because rising temperatures have altered normal routes. Some animals now remain in cities because they can easily find food from rubbish dumps instead of travelling long distances. Human development, including roads, housing and other construction, has broken up natural habitats and blocked migration paths. In addition, forests have been cleared, removing places where migrating animals can rest. These changes are worrying because staying in one area allows parasites to spread more easily. They also disrupt ecosystems by reducing insect control, seed distribution and pollination. Birds that no longer migrate may compete with local species for limited resources, while some migratory animals are declining and their journeys are becoming threatened.

Content: 9/10

已涵盖的内容:

Forrest原文

Changes in migration have happened because rising temperatures have altered normal routes.

\*很自然的paraphrase，没有直接照抄原文！很棒~

\*normal routes建议改成: usual migration routes → normal在语义上不够合适。在动物迁徙里，文章真正想表达的不是这条路线是“正常的”，另一条路线是“不正常的”，而是“动物通常会走的 / 长期以来形成的 / 原本的迁徙路线”

Some animals now remain in cities because they can easily find food from rubbish dumps instead of travelling long distances.

很棒的逻辑：容易找到食物 → 不再需要长距离迁徙

Human development, including roads, housing and other construction, has broken up natural habitats and blocked migration paths.

Forrest没有很机械地一个评分点写一句，而是把相关信息进行合理地结合到一个句子里，也用上了长难句，真厉害！

In addition, forests have been cleared, removing places where migrating animals can rest.

这里写得非常好：stopover sites → places where migrating animals can rest

之前写article也讲过这种方法，如果不知道一个东西的英文，就尝试用句子解释它“是什么”

现在Forrest举一反三啦

↑ 以上内容为回答“为什么动物迁徙发生变化” ↑

These changes are worrying because staying in one area allows parasites to spread more easily.

They also disrupt ecosystems by reducing insect control, seed distribution and pollination.

Forrest把“seed dispersal”用了 (own words) “seed distribution”，是很棒的改写能力！

Birds that no longer migrate may compete with local species for limited resources

while some migratory animals are declining and their journeys are becoming threatened.

得分点

global warming

food in landfills distracts them / junk food offers easier feeding option

urbanisation / expansion of cities / increased infrastructure

+  
habitat divided / manmade barriers

deforestation / destruction of stopover sites

migration guards against parasites

affects ecosystem (in destination/Africa)

increased competition for resources for resident non-migratory species  
some migratory animals are declining → species in decline

未涵盖的点:

attempts to solve it have failed

loss of research

(原文一共11个点, 需要涵盖10个, 即可拿到content10/10)

Writing: 5/5 (! !)

Own words用得很好

信息组合+总结能力很好

比较少无关节 (很大的进步)

字数控制非常好 (114/120)

## Question 2 (a+b)

Read Text C, The last migration, in the insert and then answer Questions 2(a)–(d) on this question paper.

### Question 2

- (a) Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined:

- (i) The vehicle that Lotta hired was inexpensive.

Cheap ✓

- (ii) Seeing the flashing signals on the computer screen stops Lotta worrying that the trackers will not work.

第一次回答: melts me with relief

第二次修改: blinking red lights ✓

- (iii) Even though there are still a few bird species left alive, there is no longer any money available to pay for scientists to study them.

第一次回答: there's no longer any funding for research

第二次修改: Some birds remain ✓

- (iv) Lotta explains how the migrating birds begin by taking different routes before they rejoin each other to find where the fish are.

merge together ✓

- (b) Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words underlined:

'I've put trackers on three, but couldn't afford cameras,' I explain, doggedly following Ennis back to his vessel. 'They'll only help to pinpoint where the birds fly. Someone needs to witness how they survive, to learn. Take me south – we'll follow them. If there are fish left, those birds will find them.'

- (i) vessel boat, ship ✓

- (ii) pinpoint find the exact location ✓

- (iii) witness see for themselves ✓ (但建议用by, 体现自己亲自看到)



## Question 2 (c)

- (c) Use one example from the text below to explain how the writer suggests Lotta's attitude to the project.

Use your own words in your explanation.

I'm not sure when dreaming of this last desperate project began, but it's part of me now as much as the instinct for breath. It swallowed me whole – a fantasy quest, securing a place on a fishing vessel and having its captain carry me far south following the longest natural migration of any living creature.

The phrase "it swallowed me whole" suggests that the project has taken over Lotta's life. She is completely absorbed in it and is willing to devote all her time and effort to discovering the birds' migration.

3/3 → 有合适的例子 (1') + comprehensive explanation (1'), 充分解释作者怎样表现Lotta对项目的态度 (1')

点评:

| Forrest原文                                                               | 得分点                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 例子选取: it swallowed me whole                                             | It swallowed me whole – a fantasy quest |
| swallowed me whole 是一个非常强的比喻, 它不是简单说: "I am interested in the project." |                                         |
| 态度: deeply absorbed / consumed / obsessed / driven                      |                                         |

|                             |                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| has taken over Lotta's life | completely consumed by the idea<br>took over <b>her thoughts</b> |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|

Forrest解释了这个比喻背后的意思: has taken over Lotta's life

但是这句分析不是特别严谨。

因为swallowed me whole强调: 她整个人被这个**想法**吞没、占据

所以更贴切的说法是 "the project has completely taken over **her thoughts** and attention"

|                                                                                                                                                            |                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| *completely absorbed in it<br>*and is willing to devote all her time and effort to<br>*discovering the birds' migration.<br>all her time and effort → 有点绝对 | completely consumed by the idea |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|

原文有表现出她极度投入, 但没有明确说 "她把 '所有' 时间都花在项目上"

想要更加严谨, 可以改成: she is willing to devote enormous time and effort to the project

## Question 2 (d)

(d) Reread paragraphs 1 and 13.

- Paragraph 1 begins 'I'm watching ...' and is about the actions of Lotta and the bird.
- Paragraph 13 begins 'Months later ...' and is about what Ennis and Lotta discover when they land at the end of their journey.

Explain how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effect in these paragraphs. Choose three examples of words or phrases from each paragraph to support your answer. Your choices should include the use of imagery.

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer.

这个回答要写在本上，拍照放在这里

In paragraph 1, the writer presents the bird as both vulnerable and determined. The phrase "a small burst of defiance" personifies the bird, suggesting it is courageously resisting Lotta despite its small size. This makes readers admire its spirit and shows that it is a wild creature unwilling to surrender. The description "Her heartbeat pounds fast and fragile inside my palm" combines sound and touch imagery. The verb "pounds" conveys the bird's fear and panic, while "fragile" reminds us how easily it could be harmed. This creates tension because Lotta is responsible for protecting such a delicate animal.

Finally, the bird "explodes free, swooping at me suddenly" is a powerful metaphor. The verb "explodes" suggests a sudden release of energy, while "swooping" emphasises its speed and agility. This dramatic image highlights the bird's strength and freedom once it escapes.

In paragraph 13, the language changes from uncertainty to wonder. The description "hundreds of terns smother an expanse of unspoiled ice" creates a striking visual image. The verb "smother" suggests the birds completely cover the landscape, emphasising how unexpectedly abundant life still is.

The birds are then described as "dipping gracefully, diving hungrily". The contrasting adverbs show both elegance and determination. Their movements seem effortless, but their hunger reminds readers that survival still depends on finding food.

Finally, the question "What else is hiding in these clean, untouched waters – this sanctuary?" uses both a rhetorical question and the metaphor "sanctuary." This suggests the place is a safe refuge where nature has survived human destruction. It leaves readers with a sense of hope and wonder that life can still flourish in an unspoiled environment.

13/15

### Paragraph 1

1. "a small burst of defiance" → 一阵短暂而微弱的反抗

- (a) **small burst of defiance**: effort to resist, show of anger or protest; a weak refusal to cooperate, though has no choice, tiny and ineffective

\*defiance = 反抗、不服从

\*burst = 突然短暂的一下

\*small = 小的、微弱的

因此，Forrest写 "courageously resisting Lotta" (勇敢地反抗Lotta)，是原文没提到的，因为原文强调的是这只鸟很小、很脆弱，但它还是本能地反抗了一下。

建议改成: **brief but determined resistance**

\*brief 对应 burst

\*resistance 对应 defiance

\*determined 表示它在反抗



2. “Her heartbeat pounds fast and fragile inside my palm” → 很好

得分点:

stress is affecting the bird's heart rate  
sounds delicate as if it might break  
emphasises the need for extreme care  
bird feels captured / imprisoned

3. “explodes free, swooping at me suddenly”

\*“is a powerful metaphor” 这句话没有什么实际分析价值

考试不会考Forrest知不知道这是metaphor, 而是考察能不能解释这个词为什么有效

因此, 建议写: The verb “explodes” suggests a sudden and forceful release of energy.

\* “swooping emphasises its speed and agility” 漏掉了 “at me” (⚠️ 很重要的信息 ⚠️)

文章原文: swooping at me → 鸟挣脱以后, 并没有只是飞走, 反而朝 Lotta 俯冲过去 (它在反击、报复 Lotta)

和前面的 “a small burst of defiance” 呼应了: 这只鸟一直都没有完全屈服!

### Paragraph 13

1. “hundreds of terns smother an expanse of unspoiled ice”

得分点:

\*release of emotion at the quantity of birds  
\*completely covering the frozen land  
\*perfect, pristine ice  
\*not destroyed by humans

Forrest原文:

completely cover the landscape → 鸟多到把整片景观都覆盖住

unexpectedly abundant life still is → 强调生命数量之多, 而且这种丰富是出乎意料的

建议加入分析 “smother” 本身给人的感觉

→ 覆盖得严严实实甚至 “闷住、窒息” 的感觉

→ 让鸟群显得数量惊人, 密集到几乎把整片冰面覆盖掉

Forrest原文: the birds completely cover the landscape → 只是在解释smother的基本意思, 没有解释writer's effect

思考一下: 为什么作者不用普通的 cover, 而要用 smother?

注意:

Forrest已经可以识别metaphor, personification, imagery, rhetorical question等等; 但是修辞名称本身几乎不值分。比如 “This is a powerful metaphor.” 其实信息量很低。Forrest真正要做的是思考: 为什么这个具体的词特别有效? 它让我们看到、听到、感觉到什么? 它有哪些额外联想?

每次答题都可以问问: What does it literally suggest? → What does it make me imagine? → What does that reveal/create here?

## New Reading Task - Text C - Question 2 (c-d) Vocabulary

Read Text C, and then answer Questions 2(a)–(d) and Question 3 on the question paper.

### Text C: The beach

structure: fun → discovery → reflection → destruction/power → conservation → hope

The narrator and her sons, Charlie and Khai, are on one of their regular afternoon visits to their local beach.

dazzling / exhilarating / laughter 一开始很快、兴奋的氛围

On this dazzling afternoon, cycling along the sea's edge is exhilarating and our laughter sends seagulls scattering skywards. The new path we're following ends abruptly and we're stranded on the wrong side of a channel of water. I show the boys that, like life, if you approach it full on, you can most times power through on sheer determination. But today the channel's deeper than it looks. I've misjudged it massively. My bike comes to a graceless halt midway, balances briefly, then falls flat on its side, depositing me spectacularly in fifty centimetres of water.

5

(a) (i)

对应题目: delicate hills of sand

We drag my bike out, giggling, and weave between the fragile dunes, emerging to find the tide low and the beach reinvented after yesterday's storm. There's been a great upheaval and something large is lying on the sand. I don't know yet that it is, or was, a ship – wrecked in 1895 on a treacherous sandbank in a gale. Its crew was rescued, but its cargo was lost.

10

unreal / magic / thrill / astonishing 看到沉船以后, 从“开心玩耍”变成“惊奇、震撼”

(a) (ii)

simile  
沉船 巨大舞台上的道具

From this distance it looks unreal, like some elaborate prop on a sweeping stage of sand. The children race towards its magic. Getting closer, I experience the same thrill. I know that these sands shift, playing an endless game of hide-and-seek. Even so, it's hard to believe this has been here, buried and invisible: a wooden vessel, rotting and exposed, its curved wooden spurs like the ribcage of some enormous extinct beast, picked clean of its flesh by the sea. The boys clamber on board like marauding cartoon pirates. This wreck is an astonishing sight.

work together X

conspire ✓

自然力量显得更神秘、更强大、更不可控制

personification

conspire “密谋、合谋”  
人才会这样

When I say that this place is changeable, what I mean is that tides, currents and weather conspire to move the sand, and objects like this skeletal old ship emerge. At other times they can't be seen. We walk unaware over the remains of the past everyday: what's left of our ancestors' artefacts – the 'physical culture', as archaeologists call it. It's dizzying, that realisation.

“看到沉船”转向“想到过去、历史、祖先遗物”

(a) (iii)

变得更深思、更有敬畏感

I often find scrap metal and glass here – mostly rubbish, carelessly discarded, but one time the unusual colour of an object intrigued us. We tried pulling it out, carefully digging sand away with our hands, but it was stuck fast, part of some bigger, bulkier thing, and wouldn't budge. Charlie stopped digging and stood back to reassess. 'It's a car,' he said tracing the familiar curve of a door. The sea that day seemed so gentle, the tide ambling quietly up the beach, that it was difficult to imagine it powerful enough to pick up an entire abandoned car. But when the westerly winds howl in, this place has a different character. Countless times I've witnessed the shore hewn and hammered, scattered with whole trees and littered with concrete fence posts.

25

海滩是“有性格”的  
有脾气的!

(a) (iv)

Until recently, cars were permitted on every part of this special shore. When restrictions were introduced, limiting the area accessible by vehicle and charging entry during summer months, there was indignation from disgruntled visitors. I suppose there will inevitably be some people who don't understand why conservation matters.

30

Treasure hunting along the shoreline is always exciting; today is spectacular. It's still not unusual to find the small egg cases of skate fish on this beach. Known locally as 'mermaids' purses', the ones I find are mostly desiccated, blackened and hardened by their time out of water. Sometimes, though, you can find one freshly cast, and quite different: soft in texture, olive brown and translucent. The chances are it's empty, its occupant already swum free. But it's just possible, especially after impressive storms, to find one unhatched. Charlie has spotted one and is pleasantly puzzled. I pick it up carefully, holding it to the light for observation. Today we're very lucky, gestation is complete – inside there's a tiny baby skate, a fragile promise for the future, almost ready to hatch.

35

40

一个即将出生的小生命 温柔 + 希望

Image

表面上是很孩子气、很轻松的比喻  
其实讲的是: 沙子不断覆盖和暴露历史遗物  
有时能看到, 有时看不到  
海滩 - changeable



Read Text C, The beach, in the insert and then answer Questions 2(a)–(d) on this question paper.

Question 2

很重要!!

题目表达 → 理解意思 → 回原文定位 → 找同义词/同义短语

- (a) Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined:

- (i) The boys and their mother have to pass through and around the delicate hills of sand to get access to the beach.

在...之间穿行  
weave between[1] ✓

场景：作者和孩子穿过沙丘来到海滩

- (ii) The goods carried by the ship that sank were never found, but the people on board were saved.

its crew was rescued[1] ✓

场景：作者介绍1895年失事沉船的情况

- (iii) It is not unusual for the narrator to discover everyday items that have been thrown away without thought on the beach.

carelessly discarded[1] ✓

场景：作者说自己经常在海滩发现被随手丢弃的垃圾

- (iv) Previously, vehicles were allowed on the beach.

permitted[1] ✓

场景：作者说明以前车辆可以进入海滩，后来才受到限制

- (b) Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words underlined:

原文词 → 结合语境理解 → 用自己的话解释

On this dazzling afternoon, cycling along the sea's edge is exhilarating and our laughter sends seagulls scattering skywards. The new path we're following ends abruptly and we're stranded on the wrong side of a channel of water.

Forrest答题比问:

修饰什么?

在讲什么场景?

能不能用简单英语把意思说出来?

- (i) dazzling: Very bright and sunny.[1] ✓

- (ii) exhilarating: Making us feel excited and full of energy.[1] ✓

- (iii) abruptly: Suddenly and without warning.[1] ✓

## Homework 1 - Text B - Question 1 (f) Summary

## Homework 2 - Text C - Question 2 (c-d)

Original article: See page 7

- (c) Use **one** example from the text below to explain how the writer suggests her feelings as she attempts to cross the channel of water on her bicycle.

**Use your own words in your explanation.**

I show the boys that, like life, if you approach it full on, you can most times power through on sheer determination. But today the channel's deeper than it looks. I've misjudged it massively. My bike comes to a graceless halt midway, balances briefly, then falls flat on its side, depositing me spectacularly in fifty centimetres of water.

\*\*\*

- (d) Reread paragraphs 3 and 7.

- Paragraph 3 begins 'From this distance ...' and is about the wreck.
- Paragraph 7 begins 'Treasure hunting ...' and is about the egg cases of fish.

Explain how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effect in these paragraphs. Choose **three** examples of words or phrases from **each** paragraph to support your answer. Your choices should include the use of imagery.

Write about 200 to 300 words.

**Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer.**